Sing It, and Link Will Play It

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In the first game, Link plays songs on a small wind instrument called an **ocarina** to solve puzzles, travel fast, and call his horse, Epona. In the new Switch 2 **remake** of The Legend of Zelda: **Ocarina** of Time, you can hum or sing a song into the **console**'s built-in **microphone**. If your tune matches a song Link can play, the game hears it and plays it for you. Players are already testing the system, and it works well. It can hear songs yelled into the **microphone**, played on a real instrument, or played from another screen. One player used a real **ocarina** to make Link play. Another got the game to hear a tune from an old video clip of a man singing something a bit like Epona's Song. The system is not perfect. If you sing something that does not sound like a song in the game, it will make its best guess. Players can usually use only five notes, but moving the **analog stick** lets them reach notes outside that range.

Word Treasure

ocarina -- A small wind instrument you blow into to make music.

remake -- A new version of an older game that has been made again.

microphone -- A device that picks up sounds so a machine can hear them.

console -- The machine you play video games on.

analog stick -- The small stick on a game controller that you tilt to move or choose things.

Background you need

An ocarina is a small wind instrument that you play by blowing into it and covering holes to change the notes.

In the game, Link plays special songs on his ocarina to do helpful things, like solve puzzles, travel fast, and call his horse Epona.

The new version listens through the console's built-in microphone, so when a player hums or sings a song Link knows, the game can hear it and play it for them.

Break it down

WHO: Link, the hero of The Legend of Zelda: Ocarina of Time, and players testing the new remake.

WHAT: In the Switch 2 remake, players can hum or sing into the console's microphone, and the game hears the tune and plays the matching song for Link.

WHERE: In the new Switch 2 remake of The Legend of Zelda: Ocarina of Time, using the console's built-in microphone.

WHY: So players can make Link play songs by singing, yelling, or using a real instrument, instead of only pressing buttons.

Why it matters

If you like singing or playing music, you can now use your own voice or instrument to control a game character.

Test what you remember

1. What small wind instrument does Link play in the first game?

- (A) A guitar
- (B) An ocarina
- (C) A flute made of metal
- (D) A drum

2. In the new Switch 2 remake, what can you do to make Link play a song?

- (A) Draw the song's notes with the stylus
- (B) Shake the console three times
- (C) Type the song's name on the screen
- (D) Hum or sing a song into the console's built-in microphone

3. What does the game do if your tune matches a song Link can play?

- (A) It gives you a new horse
- (B) It hears it and plays it for you
- (C) It turns the music off
- (D) It asks you to sing it again

4. What did one player use to make Link play a song?

- (A) A kazoo
- (B) A real ocarina
- (C) A phone ringtone
- (D) A toy piano

5. What happens if you sing something that does not sound like a song in the game?

- (A) The game stops working
- (B) It makes its best guess
- (C) It asks for a different song
- (D) It plays Epona's Song

6. How can players reach notes outside the usual five-note range?

- (A) By moving the analog stick
- (B) By singing louder
- (C) By pressing the power button
- (D) By playing a real instrument instead

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: B 4: B 5: B 6: A

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):